

New Testament





About the Course

Each year in high school, students read one of the gospels along with several other New Testament epistles. For 2026-2027 they read the gospel of Luke along with Romans, Ephesians, Hebrews, and Revelation. Using their study Bibles and other resources, students encounter scripture and seek to understand the cultural, historical, and theological context of their readings in order to more deeply appreciate the richness of the Bible and the humility needed in order to live out God's word today.

This topic is included in the following course(s): Bible: Grade 12



Placement & Combining Tips

Lessons in one of the gospels are shared across HS grades. Some epistles studied in Grade 12 are more challenging than those in younger grades, but lessons can be combined if desired. Students new to reading the Bible for themselves or unused to commentaries or study notes may find the lessons in Grades 7-8 a gentler introduction to these study practices.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
12	New Testament: Grade 12 1 time/week 30 min	NIV Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible: Bringing to Life the Ancient World of Scripture Introducing the New Testament: A Historical, Literary, and Theological Survey Luke for Everyone

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Bible: Grade 12				
Spiritual Formation: Grade 12	Old Testament: Grades 7-12	New Testament: Grade 12	Old Testament: Grades 7-12	Church History: Grades 10-12



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

Bible: Grade 12

☐ Make or purchase Bible journals for Old and New Testament studies (see some suggestions in the following course Extra Helpings: Bible: Grades 7-8, 9, 10-11, and 12).



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

New Testament: Grade 12



NIV Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible: Bringing to Life the Ancient World of Scripture



Introducing the New Testament: A Historical, Literary, and Theological Survey



Luke for Everyone



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

New Testament: Grade 12

∞ bibleproject.com

Click THIS text
or scan the QR
code for links.



New Testament: Grade 12

How To Approach



Recap

Take a moment to recall what you read previously in the same book or topic.



Read

Read the passage assigned or read for the number of minutes allocated. If a book is challenging for you, try stopping to narrate to yourself silently now and then to make sure you are tracking. Or you could listen to an audiobook version of the text and read along. You may also want to read aloud to yourself. If a book is an easy read, enjoy the ride! Keep an eye out for quotes to put in your Commonplace Book or events or characters to put down in your Book of Centuries.



Narrate

Process and integrate your reading by narrating either orally or in writing. Some lesson plans will give you a suggestion of how best to narrate. You might want to set a timer to keep yourself on track, so you stop reading with enough time to narrate.



Connect

Read notes in your Study Bible or commentary. Look up places mentioned in the text in your Bible atlas. Add something to your Book of Centuries or Commonplace Book. Jot down additional reflections and thoughts in your Bible notebook or share with others.



Teacher Note

Read over the lesson plans to familiarize yourself with the content for accountability and interest. If doing the lessons together, use a picture, a map, or an engaging question to rouse students' interest before reading. You may also highlight one or two unfamiliar terms if needed. If in a classroom context, you may choose to leave larger doctrinal conversations for students to have with their parents at home.

New Testament: Grade 12

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 1 30m New Testament: Grade 12 - Lesson 1

→ INTRO

Each year, we will be reading one of the Gospels along with our study of the rest of the New Testament books. This year, we will be reading Mark along with Romans, Ephesians, Hebrews, and Revelation. It is helpful to be continually reminded of who Jesus is and how he interacted with people. The Gospel accounts (and all the rest!) were designed to be read many times. There will be insights gained that you would only pick up after multiple readings and by paying attention to repeated words and themes.

We will make use of the Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible notes, the Chronological Guide, and some Bible Project videos/articles/podcasts to help us understand what Mark and Paul are saying to their audiences. Then we can think about what new thoughts about God we gain in the process. You do not need to read all the study notes for all the verses. Pick and choose based on which verses you have questions about. Use a digital or physical notebook to record your thoughts as you work your way through the readings.

→ VIEW & NARRATE

Today, we will set the stage for reading Mark by gaining some context. Narrate silently in your head or by talking to yourself to go over the main points. Or, jot them down in your journal.

∞ Video Link: How to Read the New Testament

∞ Video Link: How to Read the Gospel

∞ Video Link: Mark Summary

→ PRINT

You may want to print out the summary of the book to reference as you read.

∞ Image Link: Mark

→ MAP WORK

When places are named in the text refer to a map in the study Bible. Finding the places on the map is very helpful for seeing the stories in the context of the land. Sketching your own maps of journeys or regions can be helpful too.

NOTE:

This journal option contains only the Bible book text and space to write.

∞ Link: ESV Matthew Journal

WEEK 2 30m New Testament: Grade 12 - Lesson 2

📄 Materials: Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible

→ READ

Mark 1

→ NARRATE & RESPOND

Silently or orally tell back to yourself what you read. Then, in your journal, respond to what you read by putting down some of your thoughts or questions. Just like in nature study, when we ask questions such as What did I notice? What did I wonder? Or what did this remind me of? We can ask the same questions about what we read.

→ LISTEN & DISCUSS

∞ Podcast Link: Anointed

• Listen from 11:06-29:03 about the first verses of Mark. Jot down any thoughts afterwards.

★ NOTE

Instead of reading Mark for some of the lessons, consider watching and listening to Mark via the LUMO Project, which only uses the actual text of Mark but has people acting while it is read. There are many versions and many languages available. You might consider this resource for your modern language studies, too.

∞ Video Link: Lumo Project Mark

New Testament: Grade 12

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Term 1

WEEK 3 30m New Testament: Grade 12 - Lesson 3

Materials: Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible, Chronological Guide

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ

Mark 2-3

→ NARRATE & RESPOND

Silently or orally tell back to yourself what you read. Then, in your journal, respond to what you read by putting down some of your thoughts or questions. Just like in nature study, when we ask questions such as What did I notice?, What did I wonder?, or What did this remind me of?, we can ask the same questions about what we read. Repeat this same process as you work through the lessons.

★ NOTE

The Bible Project has an app with a weekly playlist to go deeper into many topics for continued study.

∞ Info Link: Bible Project App

WEEK 4 30m New Testament: Grade 12 - Lesson 4

Materials: Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible, Chronological Guide

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

Mark 4

→ VIEW & DISCUSS

∞ Video Link: How to Read the Parables

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link: Herod's Family Tree

★ NOTE

The Bible Project has an interesting podcast series on the parables if you are interested in learning more!

∞ Podcast Series Link: Decoding the Parables

WEEK 5 30m New Testament: Grade 12 - Lesson 5

Materials: Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible, Chronological Guide

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

Mark 5

→ MAP WORK

Don't forget to find place names on your maps or sketch a map that shows where the events are taking place.

WEEK 6 30m New Testament: Grade 12 - Lesson 6

Materials: Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible, Chronological Guide

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

Mark 6

→ READ

New Testament: Grade 12

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Term 1

Look in the Chronological Guide (p.152-177) for helpful articles and in your Study Bible for verse commentary and more helpful information.
Jot down your thoughts, reflections, and observations.

WEEK 7 30m New Testament: Grade 12 - Lesson 7

Materials: Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible, Chronological Guide

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

Mark 7-8

★ NOTE

Discuss with a parent, teacher, or classmate what you are learning.

WEEK 8 30m New Testament: Grade 12 - Lesson 8

Materials: Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible, Chronological Guide

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

Mark 9-10

→ READ

Look in the Chronological Guide (p.152-177) for helpful articles and in your Study Bible for verse commentary and more helpful information.
Jot down your thoughts, reflections, and observations.

WEEK 9 30m New Testament: Grade 12 - Lesson 9

Materials: Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible, Chronological Guide

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

Mark 11

WEEK 10 30m New Testament: Grade 12 - Lesson 10

Materials: Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible, Chronological Guide

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

Mark 12

WEEK 11 30m New Testament: Grade 12 - Lesson 11

Materials: Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible, Chronological Guide

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

Mark 13

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Term 1

→ VIEW

∞ Video Link: Jerusalem's Temple

∞ Article Link: Jerusalem and Temple Map

WEEK 12 30m New Testament: Grade 12 - Lesson 12

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

New Testament: Grade 12

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Term 2

WEEK 1 30m New Testament: Grade 12 - Lesson 13

Materials: Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible, Chronological Guide

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

Mark 14

→ LISTEN

∞ Podcast Link: The Exodus Way E7: Passover Psalms at the Last Supper
Listen to the beginning about what Jesus and the disciples sang. Finish if you are interested at another time.

★ NOTE

The Bible Project has a podcast series on how to read the Bible that you might find helpful.

∞ Podcast Link: How to Read the Bible

WEEK 2 30m New Testament: Grade 12 - Lesson 14

Materials: Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible, Chronological Guide

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

Mark 15-16

→ READ

∞ Article Link: The Missing End of Mark's Gospel

WEEK 3 30m New Testament: Grade 12 - Lesson 15

→ VIEW & NARRATE

∞ Video Link: How to Read the NT Letters in Historical Context

∞ Video Link: How to Read the NT Letters in Literary Context

WEEK 4 30m New Testament: Grade 12 - Lesson 16

Materials: Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible, Chronological Guide

→ VIEW

Today, we will set the stage for reading Romans by gaining some context specific to the book.

∞ Video Link: Intro to Romans (Part 1)

→ PRINT

You may want to print out the summary of the book to reference as you read Romans.

∞ Image Link: Romans Summary

→ READ

This guide might be helpful to refer to as you read Romans. It also has suggestions for further study.

∞ Article Link: Book of Romans Guide

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

Romans 1-3

Skip any articles for now, so you can focus on the text.

→ READ

Any of the verse commentary under the text for verses that might need more explanation. Pick and choose. You do not need to read all of it unless you want to.

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Term 2

→ EXPLORE

As you have time left in the lesson, or on your own:

- Skipped-over articles in your Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible
- Chronological Guide (p.196)

WEEK 5 30m New Testament: Grade 12 - Lesson 17

Materials: Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible, Chronological Guide

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ VIEW

∞ Video Link: Intro to Romans (Part 2)

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

Romans 4-6

→ EXPLORE

As you have time left in the lesson, or on your own:

- Skipped-over articles in your Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible
- Chronological Guide (p.196)

WEEK 6 30m New Testament: Grade 12 - Lesson 18

Materials: Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible, Chronological Guide

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

Romans 7-9

→ EXPLORE

As you have time left in the lesson, or on your own:

- Skipped-over articles in your Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible
- Chronological Guide (p.196-197)

★ NOTE

The Bible Project has an interesting podcast series on the letters of the NT if you are interested in learning more!

∞ Podcast Series Link: Letters of the NT

WEEK 7 30m New Testament: Grade 12 - Lesson 19

Materials: Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible, Chronological Guide

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

Romans 10-12

→ EXPLORE

As you have time left in the lesson, or on your own:

- Skipped-over articles in your Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible
- Chronological Guide (p.196-197)

★ NOTE

Discuss with a parent, teacher, or classmate what you are learning.

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Term 2

WEEK 8 30m New Testament: Grade 12 - Lesson 20

Materials: Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible, Chronological Guide

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

Romans 13-15

→ EXPLORE

As you have time left in the lesson, or on your own:

- Skipped-over articles in your Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible
- Chronological Guide

WEEK 9 30m New Testament: Grade 12 - Lesson 21

Materials: Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible, Chronological Guide

→ VIEW

Today, we will set the stage for reading Ephesians by gaining some context specific to the book.

∞ Video Link: Intro to Ephesians

→ PRINT

You may want to print out the summary of the book to reference as you read Ephesians.

∞ Image Link: Ephesians Summary

→ READ

This guide might be helpful to refer to as you read Ephesians. It also has suggestions for further study.

∞ Article Link: Book of Ephesians Guide

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

Romans 16, Ephesians 1-2

→ EXPLORE

As you have time left in the lesson, or on your own:

- Skipped-over articles in your Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible
- Chronological Guide (p.204)

WEEK 10 30m New Testament: Grade 12 - Lesson 22

Materials: Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible, Chronological Guide

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

Ephesians 3-5

→ EXPLORE

As you have time left in the lesson, or on your own:

- Skipped-over articles in your Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible
- Chronological Guide (p.204)



Term 2

WEEK 11 30m New Testament: Grade 12 - Lesson 23

 Materials: Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible, Chronological Guide

→ VIEW

Today, we will set the stage for reading Hebrews by gaining some context specific to the book.

∞ Video Link: Intro to Hebrews

→ PRINT

You may want to print out the summary of the book to reference as you read Hebrews.

∞ Image Link: Hebrews Summary

→ READ

This guide might be helpful to refer to as you read Hebrews. It also has suggestions for further study.

∞ Article Link: Book of Hebrews Guide

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

Ephesians 6, Hebrews 1-2

→ EXPLORE

As you have time left in the lesson, or on your own:

- Skipped-over articles in your Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible
- Chronological Guide (p.210-211)

WEEK 12 30m New Testament: Grade 12 - Lesson 24

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

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Term 3

WEEK 1 30m New Testament: Grade 12 - Lesson 25

Materials: Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible, Chronological Guide

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

Hebrews 3-5

→ EXPLORE

As you have time left in the lesson, or on your own:

- Skipped-over articles in your Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible
- Chronological Guide (p.210-211)

★ NOTE

The Bible Project has a podcast on Hebrews 3 that you might find helpful.

∞ Podcast Link: Hebrews: The Quest for Final Rest

WEEK 2 30m New Testament: Grade 12 - Lesson 26

Materials: Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible, Chronological Guide

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

Hebrews 6-8

→ EXPLORE

As you have time left in the lesson, or on your own:

- Skipped-over articles in your Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible
- Chronological Guide (p.210-211)

WEEK 3 30m New Testament: Grade 12 - Lesson 27

Materials: Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible, Chronological Guide

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

Hebrews 9-11

→ EXPLORE

As you have time left in the lesson, or on your own:

- Skipped-over articles in your Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible
- Chronological Guide (p.212)

WEEK 4 30m New Testament: Grade 12 - Lesson 28

Materials: Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible, Chronological Guide

→ VIEW

Today, we will set the stage for reading Revelation by gaining some context specific to the book.

∞ Video Link: Intro to Revelation (Part 1)

→ PRINT

You may want to print out the summary of the book to reference as you read Revelation.

∞ Image Link: Revelation Summary

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[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

→ READ

This guide might be helpful to refer to as you read Revelation. It also has suggestions for further study.

∞ Article Link: Book of Revelation Guide

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

Hebrews 12-13, Revelation 1

→ EXPLORE

As you have time left in the lesson, or on your own:

- Skipped-over articles in your Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible
- Chronological Guide (p.214)

WEEK 5 30m New Testament: Grade 12 - Lesson 29

Materials: Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible, Chronological Guide

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

Revelation 2-4

→ EXPLORE

As you have time left in the lesson, or on your own:

- Skipped-over articles in your Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible
- Chronological Guide (p.214)

WEEK 6 30m New Testament: Grade 12 - Lesson 30

Materials: Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible, Chronological Guide

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

Revelation 5-7

→ EXPLORE

As you have time left in the lesson, or on your own:

- Skipped-over articles in your Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible
- Chronological Guide (p.214-215)

WEEK 7 30m New Testament: Grade 12 - Lesson 31

Materials: Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible, Chronological Guide

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

Revelation 8-10

→ EXPLORE

As you have time left in the lesson, or on your own:

- Skipped-over articles in your Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible
- Chronological Guide (p.214-215)

New Testament: Grade 12

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Term 3

WEEK 8 30m New Testament: Grade 12 - Lesson 32

Materials: Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible, Chronological Guide

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ VIEW

∞ Video Link: Revelation Summary (Part 2)

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

Revelation 11-13

→ EXPLORE

As you have time left in the lesson, or on your own:

- Skipped-over articles in your Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible
- Chronological Guide (p.214-216)

★ NOTE

Discuss with a parent, teacher, or classmate what you are learning.

WEEK 9 30m New Testament: Grade 12 - Lesson 33

Materials: Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible, Chronological Guide

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

Revelation 14-16

→ EXPLORE

As you have time left in the lesson, or on your own:

- Skipped-over articles in your Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible
- Chronological Guide (p.214-216)

WEEK 10 30m New Testament: Grade 12 - Lesson 34

Materials: Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible, Chronological Guide

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

Revelation 17-19

→ EXPLORE

As you have time left in the lesson, or on your own:

- Skipped-over articles in your Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible
- Chronological Guide (p.214-216)

WEEK 11 30m New Testament: Grade 12 - Lesson 35

Materials: Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible, Chronological Guide

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

Revelation 20-22

→ EXPLORE

New Testament: Grade 12

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Term 3	
As you have time left in the lesson, or on your own: • Skipped-over articles in your Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible • Chronological Guide (p.214-217)	
WEEK 12  30m New Testament: Grade 12 - Lesson 36 <i>Exam Week</i>	
→ EXAMS Answer question(s) related to the course.	

New Testament: Grade 12

Examination

Term 1

- • NT: What was Mark's emphasis in his gospel? What new thoughts did this reading provide about who Jesus is? What other insights did you gain?

Term 2

- • NT: What is the overall structure and message of Romans? What new thoughts did this reading provide? What other insights did you gain?
- • NT: Tell the connection between unity and diversity of gifts, OR Tell the evidence of spiritual growth Paul mentions in Ephesians. What new thoughts did this reading provide? What other insights did you gain?

Term 3

- • NT: Discuss Jesus, High Priest of a Better Covenant, in Hebrews 8 and relate it to your OT readings. OR Tell what you know of the authorship and aim of the letter to the Hebrews. At what points does the author show the supremacy of Christ? (You can use your Bible to give quotations.) What new thoughts did this reading provide? What other insights did you gain?
- • NT: What is the structure of Revelation, and what is the main message? What new thoughts did this reading provide? What other insights did you gain?